

Curries Across the Subcontinent

From the majestic Himalayas in the north and the deserts and jungles of the center to the tropical southern coastline, each Indian region produces a range of delicious, distinctive dishes.

KERALA

Paragon inexpensive

Kannur Road, Kozhikode; www.paragonrestaurant.net
This is one of the oldest and most highly rated places to sample authentic Malabari cuisine, such as *meen moilee* (fish in coconut milk) or fish-and-mango curry.

Arca Nova moderate

Fort House Hotel, 2/6A Calvathy Road, Kochi; +91 484 221 7103

This hotel's peaceful candlelit jetty is a very romantic spot to enjoy *meen moilee* and other Keralan seafood specialties or more simple grilled fish steaks.

Costa Malabari moderate

Thottada, south of Kannur; +91 484 237 1761

This trio of homestay bungalows, just behind an idyllic strip of coast, can rustle up a mean *meen moilee*, as well as other home-style Keralan recipes.

KASHMIR

The idyllically situated Kashmir Valley, hemmed in by towering Himalayan ranges, has a predominantly Muslim population whose heavily meat-based cuisine, known as *wazwan*, includes the worldwide favorite *rogan josh* – meat in a richly spiced tomato sauce.

Juniper Hotel inexpensive

Lal Chowk, Srinagar; +91 194 247 1031

This popular restaurant is well known for its fine Kashmiri dishes, including *rogan josh* and *syun kaliya*, lamb curry with a yogurt and turmeric base.

Mughal Darbar moderate

Residency Road, Srinagar; www.mughal-darbar.com

This elegantly decorated restaurant within the hotel of the same name is a great place to sample authentic Kashmiri *wazwan* cuisine; it's a favorite with locals and visitors alike.

Pahalgam Hotel moderate

Main Bazaar, Pahalgam; www.pahalgamhotel.com

The restaurant at this smart alpine-style hotel is suitably lavish and serves up quality *wazwan* dishes such as *rogan josh*, as well as fresh trout from the adjacent Lidder River.

Below left Chicken biryani **Below The** floating vegetable market on Dal Lake in Srinagar, Kashmir, is the only one of its kind in India **Right (top to bottom)** Sunset over a beachside restaurant in

Goa; the fiery curry of vindaloo, developed in Goa, is a vinegar-and-chili-pepper-based meat dish; the Gariahat Fish Market in Kolkata is several decades old and the largest in the city



On the Menu

Bhel puri Popular form of *chaat* (see pp192–3), made with *puri*, puffed rice, chopped onions and tomatoes, cilantro leaves, lime, and various spices.
Biryani Basmati rice cooked with meat, chicken, or vegetables and a seasoning of garlic, cardamom, cinnamon, turmeric, bay leaves, ginger, and sometimes cloves.
Chaat Street snacks, usually based on crispy fried *puri*.
Dosa Rice-flour and lentil pancake.
Garam masala Combination of spices such as ginger, turmeric, cloves, cumin, cardamom, and star anise; varies by region.
Gatta curry Gram-flour dumplings cooked in a yogurt and tomato gravy with garam masala, coriander, chili pepper, turmeric, and fennel.

Gram flour Chickpea flour.

Idli A circular steamed white patty made of ground rice and lentils.

Masala dosa The most popular south Indian pancake, stuffed with *sabji* and served with *sambar* and coconut chutney.

Pakora Vegetable fritters.

Paneer Unsalted white cheese.

Prawn malai curry A Bengali dish of shrimp cooked in a sauce of yogurt, cumin, chili peppers, coriander, turmeric, and ground coconut.

Puri Puffed flatbread, usually fried.

Rasam Very thin, yellow, lentil-based sauce, usually including tamarind.

Rogan josh Meat cooked in a rich tomato sauce with garlic, turmeric, coriander, cumin, chili pepper, and garam masala.

Sabji A dry vegetable curry, usually made with potato and onions and seasoned

with garlic, turmeric, and chili pepper.

Sambar Spicy sauce with a tomato and lentil base that accompanies many south Indian dishes.

Samosa Triangular fried pastry snack; in India, usually filled with vegetables.

Tandoori Food cooked in a clay oven with a spicy yogurt marinade, tinted red by cayenne or chili pepper.

Thali South Indian rice plate with a set of accompanying vegetable curry dishes and sauces (see pp210–11).

Tikka Lightly seasoned barbecued meat, often chicken.

Vada Small doughnut-shaped savory fritter, made from lentil and gram flours.

Vindaloo Meat cooked in a hot sauce of chili pepper, vinegar, cloves, cardamom, cinnamon, peppercorns, turmeric, coriander, and ginger. Potatoes are a Western addition.